```
            .build();

    try {
        var httpResponse = httpClient.send(httpRequest,
                BodyHandlers.ofString());

        if (httpResponse.statusCode() == 200) {
            var json = new JSONObject(httpResponse.body());

            if (json.getBoolean("active")) {    #D
                return processResponse(json);    #D
            }
        }
    } catch (IOException e) {
        throw new RuntimeException(e);
    } catch (InterruptedException e) {
        Thread.currentThread().interrupt();
        throw new RuntimeException(e);
    }

    return Optional.empty();
}
```

#A Validate the token first.
#B Encode the token into the POST form body.
#C Call the introspection endpoint using your client credentials.
#D Check that the token is still active.

Several optional fields are allowed in the JSON response, including all valid JWT claims (see chapter 6). The most important fields are listed in table 7.1. Because all these fields are optional, you should be prepared for them to be missing. This is an unfortunate aspect of the specification, as there is often no alternative but to reject a token if its